Sebastián Raúl Vansteenkiste

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Senior Software Engineer · Full-Stack · Leader · Barcelona, Spain · +34 644 063 358 · ☎cal
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SUMMARY

Senior Fullstack Developer & Engineering Leader with 12+ years of experience owning the full product lifecycle. I can successfully bridge the gap between complex business requirements, UX design, and technical execution, including development, testing and deployment. I specialize in modernizing high-stakes legacy systems, but I also enjoy building resilient, zero-to-production architectures from scratch. I also have successfully led teams of 10+ (human) developers in the timely delivery of several initiatives.

I'm currently committed full-time to a client project, however I'm available part-time for initiatives that fit my areas of expertise, or for full-time opportunities if the proposal and compensation are serious.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C# · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TypeScript · HTML · CSS / SCSS
Frontend: React · Angular · Blazor (Razor) · Xamarin · Bootstrap · PWA / SPA · micro-frontends
Backend: .NET · ASP.NET · Django · Django REST Framework · Node.js · REST · GraphQL · SOAP
Databases: MS SQL Server · MySQL · SQLite · MongoDB · CosmosDB
Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure (App Services, Functions, Queues, Blobs, CosmosDB) · AWS (Lambdas, EC2, S3) · microservices · Docker · Linux VPS · Git · CI/CD pipelines · Postman
Engineering Leadership: Conflict resolution · Team leadership & mentoring · Hiring & technical interviewing · Remote/highly-distributed & multicultural team management
Practices: TDD · Agile/Scrum · Code review · Technical documentation · Process documentation & Improvement · Stakeholder interviews · Sprint planning & prioritization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer · SRVans · Remote | Jan 2026 – present

Developed personal and client-requested projects, end-to-end from requirements gathering to finished product, both manually and AI-assisted:

- **omakase**: PWA based offline Japanese reference lookup with focus on UX. omakase-kun.pages.dev | github.com/zippolag/omakase
- **Legacy Monolith Modernisation Specialist** via **Malt.es**

Engineering Manager / Team Lead · Hitachi Energy · Barcelona, Spain | Sep 2024 – Dec 2025

Led a distributed, multicultural team of 10 developers managing the Digital Passport System (DPS), a global component-traceability platform for high-voltage products with data integrations with manufacturing execution systems (MES). Acted as a "hands-on manager" bridging the gap between business strategy and complex technical execution.

- **Technical Stewardship:** Navigated a highly complex legacy environments: performed technical prospecting and feasibility studies for feature requests. Iterated over existing CI/CD pipelines.
- **Engineering Quality:** Defined best practices. Drove system reliability through deep code reviews and architectural unblocking, ensuring developers across Spain, India, Romania and Ukraine maintained standards despite significant performance constraints.
- **People Leadership:** Served as Line Manager for the Spain-based cohort, leading technical hiring, 1:1s, performance reviews, and conflict resolution with a focus on empathy and professional growth.
- **Process Evolution:** Established and documented foundational development workflows and release practices, successfully reducing meeting overhead and improving transparency between Product and Engineering.
- **Strategic Advocacy:** Collaborated with global stakeholders to align priorities, advocating for long-term stability and performance improvements over feature-heavy backlogs in a mission-critical production environment.

Senior Full-Stack Developer (.NET / Blazor) · **KopiusTech → HCHB** · Remote | Apr 2023 – Jul 2024

Architected and developed core modules for a Blazor + Piral micro-frontend application, modernizing a legacy WinForms-over-Citrix system for a major US healthcare provider (HCHB). Acted as a technical anchor and interim lead for "The Terminators" (web scheduler) team in charge of “eliminating Citrix” from the stack.

- **Technical Innovation:** provided and documented a method to run the entire application stack locally, enabling end-to-end debugging and drastically reducing resolution time for complex issues.
- **Modernization Strategy:** Led the transition from a slow, Citrix-based legacy environment to a high-performance micro-frontend architecture, solving critical user experience bottlenecks like boot-up slowness and lack of SSO.
- **Architectural Advocacy:** Navigated a fragmented technical landscape (GraphQL, custom ORMs, and deep SQL logic), documented it and eased best practice adoption for all teams.
- **Collaborative Leadership:** Stepped in as interim lead to represent the team in high-level architectural and business discussions, bridging gaps between BAs, designers, and mobile/infrastructure teams.
- **Mentorship:** Shared expertise through technical screening and a webinar ("Blazor: Straight to the meat"), fostering technical excellence across the distributed organization.

Senior Backend Developer (.NET / Azure) · **Svitla → ASA Financial** · Remote | Jul 2022 – Mar 2023

- Built serverless Azure Functions integrating third-party financial systems; standardized API interfaces across solutions advocating for security and steering towards a microservices architecture.
- Documented existing architecture and business logic, reducing onboarding friction and surfacing improvement areas.

Senior Full-Stack Developer (React / .NET) · **CloudX** · Remote | Jul 2021 – May 2022

- Maintained multiple client projects across industries, most with C# REST APIs in a backend-for-frontend (BFF) architecture and React (JS / TypeScript) micro-frontends.
- Worked across relational and NoSQL databases; contributed to SonarQube-gated quality pipelines.

Independent Senior Developer (multi stack) · **ThinkerSys → IRC** · Remote | Jul 2018 – Jun 2021

Lead Technical Analyst and Developer for multiple mission-critical applications at the International Rescue Committee (IRC). Owned the full product lifecycle from stakeholder discovery to global deployment, adding strategic value by catching UX and architectural issues early through PoCs and prototypes.

- **Strategic Value & UX:** Actively influenced the design phase during refinement meetings and PoCs; provided welcomed input on accessibility, responsive design, and general interactive flow, ensuring technical feasibility and user-centricity.
- **Modernization & i18n:** Led critical improvements for cuentanos.org, including complex database schema migrations and the re-implementation of translation plugins to resolve long-standing language-picker conflicts (i18n/l10n).
- **Complex Integrations:** Engineered high-reliability sync systems using Azure Functions and queues, including a Mastercard-transaction sync (SFTP, signature verification, decryption) and a cVent/Salesforce automation requiring careful handling of idempotency and traceability.
- **Workflow Optimization:** Developed custom async/batch Excel-import tools for Django-CMS to support existing admin workflows while bridging them into a modern web-app UI.
- **Global Stakeholder Management:** Translated complex vision into technical roadmaps; established direct support channels for global key users, ensuring rapid iterative refinement based on mission needs.

Tech/Team Lead & .NET Developer · **Globant → Deloitte** · Rosario, Argentina | Mar 2017 – Jul 2018

- Led a team of 12 building the “RCM” application with Xamarin iOS/Android + backend app from scratch
- Led a team of 4 maintaining the feature-packed legacy enterprise “Magnet” project with a similar stack.

Software Engineer · **Accenture → CIO (Internal)** · Rosario, Argentina | Mar 2014 – Feb 2017

- Evolved from “Software Engineering Associate” to “SE Analyst” while developing a complex enterprise financial forecasting system known as “Manage My Engagements” (MME) with VB.Net, C#, SQL and HTML+JS.
- Automated team pain-points by developing internal tools including a Visual Studio extension.
- Resolved complex cross-functional bugs down to mismatching decimals on financial numbers calculated via different formulas in different application screens for the financial engine.

EDUCATION

Information Systems Engineering (undergraduate, coursework completed, degree not pursued) · Universidad Tecnológica Nacional, Rosario · 2006–2013

Personal & Professional Computing Technician · Complejo Educativo Dr. Francisco de Gurruchaga · 2003–2005

LANGUAGES & OTHER

Spanish (native) · **English** (bilingual) · **Japanese** (intermediate - JLPT N4) · **Catalan** (basic - CPNL B1)

Legal status: Spanish resident (NIE + NUSS); dual Argentine/Italian citizenship; valid passports for both and B1 driver license.

Outside work: Founder and former instructor at Rosario Budokan dojo; 2-dan KENDŌ, 1-dan IAIDŌ and 1kyuu JŌDŌ practitioner. Bilingual (EN/ES) interpreter and translator for international projects. Hobbyist game developer. Short fiction and technical writer. Currently researching: Local-agentic AI systems, CAD+simulation software with MPI for HPC, electromagnetism and plasma physics. Currently re-booting my blog at zippolag.medium.com with AI-related articles, sharing what I've learned in the recent months aimed at a widely non-technical audience.